The seafood must be just-cooked, so cut dense fish in small pieces or add it earlier. Try red mullet, bass, haddock, cod, salmon, turbot, raw shrimp, or scallops.

north sea fish soup

SERVES 4 **PREP TIME** 20 MINS **COOK** 20 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

1lb 2oz (500g) mixed fish fillets and shellfish
salt and frehly ground black pepper
1 tbsp lemon juice
2½ cups fish or chicken stock
¼ cup white wine
2 shallots, chopped
1 egg yolk
1 tbsp heavy cream
1 tomato, peeled, seeded, and chopped
1 tbsp chopped parsley
croûtons, to serve

1 Skin the fish, if necessary, and cut into 1in (2.5cm) pieces. Season and add the lemon juice. Bring the stock, white wine, and shallots to a boil in a large saucepan.

2 Add the fish in the order it takes to cook depending on which you are using: red mullet or bass first, 2 minutes later the turbot, if using, followed by any haddock, cod, or salmon and, finally, shrimp or scallops. Simmer uncovered until all the fish is just cooked.

3 Stir the egg yolk and cream together in a bowl. Remove the soup from the heat, stir in the egg mixture, then add the tomato and parsley. Serve with croûtons.